



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

Nov 2018

November

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SUNDAY WORSHIP -FALL SCHEDULE

9:00 AM WORSHIP WITH ORGAN AND CHOIR.

10:00 am Education & Fellowship

11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in November

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
Notes: The calendar is accurate, to the best of our knowledge, at the time of printing. Dates and details may change at any time. Please visit www.minnehaha.org to view an up-to-date version of the calendar, and please contact Heather before scheduling any meetings or events. If they aren't on the calendar, you are not guaranteed a meeting space.				1 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music (BMM) 2:30p BMM 4:30p BMM	2 10a Al-Anon 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p RCA	3 8:00a Brighter Minds Music BMM 9:00a BMM 9:30a BMM
4 DAYLIGHT SAVINGS ENDS COMMUNION 9a Worship w/Organ 10:15 Faith Forum/ Sunday School 11a Worship w/Band 3p Youth Group 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	5 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p BMM 6:30p Bible Study 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Finance 6:30p World Religions - Hinduism	6 ELECTION DAY We are a polling place. 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters (Tale Weavers)	7 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wednesday Night Dinner 6:45p Choir 7:00p Children's Council	8 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a BMM 10a Scandalous Gospel of Jesus 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p BMM	9 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA 6:30 Boy Scouts 7p Fellowship Hall reserved 7p Taize	10 Bazaar 8:00a BMM 9:00a BMM 9:30a BMM 12 n - Meditation Class
11 Boy Scout Pancake Breakfast 9a Worship w/Organ 10:15 Faith Forum/ Sunday School 11a Worship w/Band 3p Youth Group 7p SAA	12 Veteran's Day Observed 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p BMM 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p World Religions—Buddhism	13 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p BMM 6:30p Nokomis Neighborhood Group 6:30p Church Council	14 5:30p Methodicals 5:30p Wed. Dinner 6:45p Choir	15 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a BMM 10a Scandalous Gospel of Jesus 2:30p BMM	16 Newsletter items due 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	17 7a Minneharvest 8:00a BMM 9:00a BMM 9:30a BMM 12 n - Meditation Class 5:00p SAA Event
18 9a Worship w/ Organ 10:15 Faith Forum/ Sunday School 11a Worship w/Band 3p Youth Group 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	19 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p BMM 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p World Religions - Judaism	20 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p BMM 6:30p Worship Committee 6:30p Toastmasters (Taleweavers)	21 5p Methodicals 6:45p Choir 7:00p Ecumenical Thanksgiving Eve	22 Thanksgiving Day Office Closed	23 9a Newsletter Collation 10a Al-Anon 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p RCA	24
25 9a Worship w/ Organ 10:15 Advent Wreath Making 11a Worship w/Band 7p SAA	26 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p BMM 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p World Religions - Islam	27 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p BMM 6:30p SPR	28 5:30p Methodicals 5:30p Wed. Dinner 6:45p Choir	29 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a BMM 10a Scandalous Gospel of Jesus 2:30p BMM 4:30p BMM 6:30 Toastmasters (Taleweavers)	30 10a Al-Anon 10:30a BMM 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p RCA	

Good Things Happen is the newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church, published each month.

The deadline for December is November 16

Contributions may be brought to the office or emailed to: office@minnehaha.org

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Worship in November

We begin the month of November with our All Saints Sunday, take some time to focus on gratitude, and then conclude with exploring where God might be leading us next. All of that will lead us up to Advent, which begins the first Sunday in December. See you in worship!

4th	“The Greatest Commandment” <i>Remembrance of the Saints ; Communion</i>	Mark 12:28-34
11th	“Giving With Joy”	Mark 12:38-34
18th	“Giving in Response”	I Samuel 2:1-10
21st	Ecumenical Thanksgiving Eve Service	7:00 p.m. @ Minnehaha UMC
25th	“Listening for God’s Voice”	John 18:33-37

Save the Date

Future special events at Minnehaha UMC:

Dec. 1 – Advent Party

Dec. 14 – Blue Christmas Taize

Dec. 16 – Christmas Pageant

Dec. 24 – Christmas Eve services at 4:00 & 10:00

Dec. 30 – One service at 10:00

Jan. 9 – Food Shelf Pasta Dinner

Jan. 13 – Infant Recognition

Jan. 20 – Annual Meeting

Jan. 25-27 – Winter Retreat at Koronis Assembly Grounds

Feb. 9-10 – Annual Musical

Feb. 23 – My Changing Self Workshop for children and youth

Feb. 23-26 – Special United Methodist General Conference in St. Louis, MO

Elections



Just a reminder that Tuesday, November 6 is the date of the elections. Not only is this an encouragement to vote, but it is a reminder that Minnehaha UMC is a polling place. You may have noticed that since it is a Tuesday, it is also a Food Shelf day. If you use Minnehaha as your polling place, just be aware that both events are happening at the same day; your patience and attitude of hospitality would be greatly appreciated.

Time Change

It will soon be time to fall back and gain that hour we lost in the spring. Set your clocks back one hour before coming to worship on Sunday, Nov. 4. If you forget, we'll have some coffee on for you as you wait for everyone else to arrive.



Minnehaha Children, Youth, and Family Ministries



Folks that have been around Minnehaha this past month might have noticed me hobbling around. One misstep while out enjoying a beautiful autumnal day landed me in the ER with a dislocated ankle, and six weeks in a boot (hopefully no more). It's been good to look to the trees in inspiration: to see the power and the beauty in their letting go. Those leaves which nourished the trees throughout the summer are released to the ground, are beautiful falling to the ground, return to the earth to continue to nourish. The trees must let go of them. It's part of their life cycle, it's what allows them to survive.

There are things in our lives that nourish us in one season, but might need to be let go off in another. There are things that we must let go of in order to survive and thrive. Being forced to slow down makes

this reality more stark. When hands are needed for crutches, they simply cannot keep as many balls juggling in the air. So, I am grateful for people who remind me that it's okay to let some drop. I am grateful for the inspiration of the trees. I am also grateful for the compassion and generosity of people who take on new tasks or share in responsibilities. It's what being a part of a community is all about.

So, as we move into a new month, I hope that you & your families find moments for gratitude, and for clarity in what things can be let go of as you continually move into a new season. I hope that Minnehaha is a place where you find – with grace – the courage to continually grow and change and nourish yourselves and others.

In gratitude,
Jenia Strom
Interim Director of Children & Family Ministries



YOUTH
@ Minnehaha UMC

NOVEMBER AT MINNEHAHA

Minnehaha Youth Group For 6th-12th Graders

Wednesday, November 7th: Learn About & Celebrate the Hindu Diwali Celebration (Festival of Lights) 6:15-7pm

Sunday, November 11th: Somali Mall
Meet at church at 3pm, we'll take the light rail to the Somali Mall and return by 6pm

Wednesday, November 14th: The Youth Take On the Kitchen, 6:15-7pm

Wednesday, November 28th: Baking Bread for Communion, 6:15-7pm

Middle School Youth Group For 6th & 7th graders

November 4th & 18th: Youth Group from 3-4:30pm
NO YOUTH GROUP on November 25th

Confirmation For 8th & 9th Graders

November 4th & 11th (mentor night) from 3-4:30pm
NO CONFIRMATION on November 25th

Minnehaha Senior High Youth For Eighth-Twelfth Graders

Sunday, Nov. 11th at 10:15am: For Parent & Youth:
Mission experience planning meeting

7pm on Friday, Nov. 16th -9am on Saturday, Nov. 17th:
Lock-In at Minnehaha UMC

For I was hungry, and you gave me food...



Celebrate Thanksgiving with the Minnehaha UMC Community
by bringing food for our food shelf.

In recognition of Thanksgiving, we encourage you to bring canned food
with you on November 4th, 11th, 18th and 21st
(or anytime during these weeks).

Currently, the Food Shelf is in need of: hearty soups, canned fruits &
vegetables, one dish meals, and personal care items. Monetary Donations
are also always welcome. Thank you for your generosity!

ALL CHILDREN ARE INVITED TO PROCESS FORWARD at the beginning of
worship WITH OUR FOOD DONATIONS on November 18th.

MINNEHARVEST

a food mission of minnehaha united methodist church

One out of six Minnesotans goes hungry on a regular basis. Our free food give-away once a month is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. Please join us this month on Saturday, November 17 (a week earlier than usual due to Thanksgiving). You can volunteer anytime between 7:00 and 10:30 a.m. We unload the trucks starting at 7, serve the food at 9:00, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us, and bring a friend!

Invitation to Speak to Delegates on Issue of Human Sexuality

In February 2019 the United Methodist Church will hold a Special Session of General Conference to discuss the UMC's stance on the area of human sexuality. A group of clergy, laity, and bishops known as the "Commission on the Way Forward" has been working diligently on this issue and has prepared three different plans that they will present to General Conference on the possible ways that the church will move forward surrounding this issue. These decisions may have significant effect on the structure of the global UMC.

The General Conference delegates and bishop from the MN area, in an effort to hear all voices of those they represent within the UMC, are holding a comment session in 15 minute slots on November 17th from 9 am to 3 pm at Portland Avenue UMC. You may email judy@haumc.org to sign up for a slot for yourself. Also, if there is interest in attending as a group from MUMC or if you are unable to attend but have thoughts that you want passed along, please contact Ashley Smit at Ashley.e.smit@gmail.com or 316-706-7646.

To obtain more information on the three plans in question – please visit <https://www.minnesotaumc.org/newsdetail/a-way-forward-the-three-plans-and-resources-for-churches-11499165> or see Pastor Becky for a paper copy.





Time for Renewal

It's easy to get caught up in the daily demands of life. In our busyness, we can lose track of ourselves, and of what God is calling us to be and to do. Take an opportunity to slow down, to rest in silence and music, and to feed your soul. On the second Friday of each month at 7:00 p.m. from October through May, we offer a Taize service, a time of sanctuary, a time for prayer, a time for community, and a time for silence. As we sing and pray, our hearts are opened so that we may hear God speaking to us, and our souls are fed so that we may be about God's work in the world. Please join us this month on Nov. 9 for a time of renewal.

World Religions

A new 6-week class will begin on Monday, Nov. 5 from 6:30-8:00. Utilizing a video series, we'll learn about the major religions of the world – Hinduism, Buddhism, Judaism, and Islam -- as well as learn a bit more about the differences in Christianity between Protestants, Catholics, and Orthodox. There is no need to prepare anything beforehand, just come to class (room 210), watch the dvd, and engage in conversation.

All Saints Sunday

We will be celebrating All Saints Sunday on November 4 at both worship services, reading the names of all the members of the congregation who have died since the last All Saints Sunday, remembering their lives and their ministry among us. If you know of any family members or good friends of people who have died in the last year, please be sure to extend an invitation to them to join us at either service.

Monthly Communion at Nokomis Square

A brief service of communion is offered at Nokomis Square on the second Thursday of this month. All are welcome to join us on November 8 at 1:00 p.m. Prior to communion, we'll learn about the Amish.

Celtic Christianity Class

This summer eleven of us enjoyed the experience of a study group on Mary Magdalene and how the loss of her influence may have contributed to the male dominance of the institutionalized church. We each read different books over the course of six weeks and shared what we found with regard to specific questions. We followed leads that took us to France and England, learned about Black Madonnas, Cathars, Gnostics and Templars, and we shared our own doubts and possible heresies. If you see one of us in a Heretic tee shirt, ask us the reason we are wearing it. Several of us are reading the New New Testament and we have decided to pursue another group looking at Celtic Christianity. One reason for this is that women remained as leaders much longer in the Celtic church.

If you are interested in being a part of a study group on Celtic Christianity beginning in late January, please indicate your interest to Becky with times you would prefer to meet. Mary Vrabel has suggested some resources we might look at and we would probably use the same format. Each person could choose what they wish to read and we can then share our learning experiences. The resources are: *Anam Car* by John O'Donahue, *Christ of the Celts* and *Listening to the Heartbeat of God* by John Phillip Newell. We will also consider using Caitlin Matthews as a resource.

It's time for Advent.
Time to: Prepare. Focus. Hope. Love. Wonder. Breath.
It's time to prepare our hearts.
It's time to share the story & to share the light.



Join us as we begin the Advent season with an

Advent Wreath Making Party for All Ages

Minnehaha United Methodist Church
Sunday, November 25th
10am in the Narthex
Cost for each wreath: \$8

Proceeds go to Minnehaha's Children & Family Ministries

Holiday Bazaar

The Annual Christmas Bazaar of the Minnehaha United Methodist Women

Saturday, November 10, 2018

9:00 a.m. – 2:00 p.m.



Gifts, Crafts, Fine Art, Antiques, Collectibles, Food and More!



Minnehaha United Methodist Church
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Annual Holiday Bazaar

By the Minnehaha United Methodist Women (UMW)

Saturday, November 10, 2018

from 9am – 2pm

Our annual Holiday Bazaar is coming up fast! Make sure to mark your calendars **NOW** to save the date. It's a great way to jump start your holiday shopping. Spread the word to your friends, family, coworkers, and neighbors!

This is the main mission fundraiser of the year for UMW and as always, many hands make for light work. We are always looking for help in these areas: **Greeters, Cashiering, Children's Boutique, the Kitchen, Waitressing, Dishwashing, the Dessert Table, General Set-up, Granny's Corner, UMW Store and Cleanup.** Men can help too.

Look for a list of options posted on the sign-up board in the Narthex or contact Karen Anderson, Kitty Campbell, or Maureen Trepp so they can add you on! Phone numbers are listed below.

We also accept these types of donations:

Bake Sale: Homemade baked goods – cookies, cupcakes, and bars

Dessert Table: Homemade desserts – cakes and pies (especially pumpkin)

UMW Crafter's table: Homemade crafts – knitted, stitched, crocheted, painted, etc...

Children's Boutique: New items that a Mom and Dad might enjoy receiving from a young child at Christmas time.

Bring **non-perishable** items to the stage area Sunday, November 4 through Thursday, November 8.

Bring **perishable** items on Friday or Saturday morning, November 9 or 10.

Contact Karen Anderson – 612-229-8397, Kitty Campbell – 612-251-6270, or Maureen Trepp - 612-724-7620 to volunteer or with questions.

WHERE DOES OUR MISSION MONEY GO?

Your generosity will be shared with these following missions:

National Division of the United Methodist Women: Global Mission Projects including UMCOR (United Methodist Council on Relief), **Haiti Solar Oven Project:** Providing solar ovens for cooking and water pasteurization, **Emma Norton Services:** Serving women and children in need of supportive housing, **Joyce Pre-School:** Quality preschool education for children of diverse backgrounds, **Simpson Shelter:** Serving families experiencing homelessness, **Walker Care Fund:** Providing funds for the special needs of Walker residents.

Your generosity will also help support these Minnehaha programs:

Food Shelf: Food distribution to local residents, **Minneharvest:** Food distribution with no resident restrictions, **Youth:** Mission programs and educational scholarships, **Hospitality:** Kitchen expenses and supportive community, **Pastor's Discretionary Fund:** Support for those with special needs, **UMW:** Speakers, Literature/Reading program, and School of Christian Mission.

THANK YOU!

Come Deck the Halls of Minnehaha UMC!

(Fa La La La La)

 **Saturday, December 1 • 9:30 – 11:30 a.m.** 

Join us on Saturday morning, December 1, from 9:30 to 11:30 a.m. to prepare Minnehaha UMC for the joyous season of Advent.



Go on a Christmas tree pilgrimage. (It's not that far.)



Sing your favorite Christmas carols.



Decorate the Sanctuary, Narthex, and Fellowship Hall. (Meet new people! Have fun!)



Color Christmas-themed murals in the Narthex.



Find inner peace and good cheer with doughnuts, coffee, and hot cocoa.



Fold origami stars. (No experience necessary.)



Bring cookie dough or ingredients (or 8-10 dozen already-made cookies). At noon after baking, we'll trade and also set some aside to give as Christmas gifts to the homebound.



Paint amazing non-permanent Christmas scenes on the front windows.

All ages are welcome. (And invited!)





We are hosting our ecumenical Thanksgiving Eve service this year on Wednesday, Nov. 21 at 7:00 p.m. Also joining us will be the congregations of Lake Nokomis Lutheran, St. James Episcopal on the Parkway, Living Table UCC, Bread of Life Deaf Lutheran, Bethel Evangelical Lutheran, Hope Lutheran and Minnehaha Communion Lutheran Church. There will be a mass choir (which anyone is welcome to join) with a joint rehearsal prior to the worship service at 6:00. We'll have some time to meet each other and renew ongoing relationships afterwards, so if you can help out by bringing a pie to share with others, that would be great. Pies can be home-made or store-bought, and as simple or as complicated as you want. We look forward to seeing you the night before Thanksgiving as we come to God with gratitude for all that God has given us.



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9:30-11:30am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.





This practice of looking around at all the things I can see on the trail is one I try to practice once I'm back in the city. I try to pay attention to my neighbors out and about, my neighbors that live behind tall fences or closed curtains, my neighbors that I sometimes pass right on by because they wear the uniforms of mail or package delivery, cashier, fast-food server, etc. The good news is that I don't have to wait until leaf-out season to notice neighbors. While I am reminded to pay better attention this time of year, it's something I can practice at any time of the year. I invite you, in this leaf-out season, to look around. Where are we in God's creation? What are the things around us that we can give God thanks for? And what/who around us can we reach out to, as we practice loving God and loving neighbor?

Becky



Just a reminder that on November 25, we need your pledge cards turned in for our 2019 financial year. Please consider taking a step up in your pledge (from 5% to 6% of your income, for example) for the operating budget. In addition, we are asking for 3-year pledges for our building fund. This will be our 4th campaign for the renovations we did about 10 years ago, and it would be great if it were our last. We want to raise at least \$200,000 towards the \$350,000 we have remaining on our loan. We will need to re-finance one more time (and interest rates are now rising again), so the smaller amount that is, the less the rise in interest rates will impact us. The goal is to be able to fold the rest of our debt into our operating budget in 3 years' time. Doing that will free us up to tackle other building-related projects that are sitting on our horizon (like the Fellowship Hall and the Gym). If you have misplaced your pledge cards, there will be some available outside the sanctuary as well. Help us to Lighten our Load so we can Broaden our View!



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10/18



About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011